THE GUIDE

Vibe Editing Studio

Turn raw talking-head footage into **finished, captioned vertical clips** - and make the covers to go with them - from one Claude Code setup. Free and open source.



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I edit my videos with this kit
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What it does

1 - EDIT A VIDEO

Raw footage in, captioned 9:16 clips out. The kit transcribes your take, picks the best moments, cuts them, face-tracks to vertical, styles the captions, and renders. You drive it by telling Claude Code what you want, in plain language.

2 - MAKE THE COVER

A photo, or a frame pulled from your video, plus a headline becomes a YouTube thumbnail (1280×720) and a vertical cover (1080×1920) in your brand, with platform safe zones handled for you.

3 - WHERE YOUR FOOTAGE GOES

Cutting and rendering happen on your machine, and your originals are never modified: the kit reads them and writes new files to an output folder you choose. The local captioning path keeps your audio on your machine too. Two things do leave it by choice: Claude Code (the assistant driving the kit) processes your transcripts and instructions under your own Claude plan, and if you pick the paid cloud transcription instead of the local fallback, that audio goes to that provider.

What you need

- A **Mac or Linux** machine, with **Claude Code**.
- **Homebrew** (macOS) so setup can install ffmpeg and friends; on Linux, your package manager.
- Your own keys for anything that costs money. They stay in a local file on your machine - never in the repo, and the kit never shares them.

What it costs, honestly

- **The kit itself: free**, and open source (MIT).
- **Claude Code:** you need access (subscription or API).
- **Transcription:** the default path uses AssemblyAI, a paid pay-as-you-go API. A local offline fallback (faster-whisper) is included if you prefer not to pay - it's slower and needs no key.
- **Everything else it installs** (ffmpeg, fonts, the cover builder) is free.
- **Optional extras** (Gemini listener notes, Frame.io/Monday delivery, Buffer scheduling) connect only if you choose them, on your own accounts; some have their own paid plans.

Get it running

Everything lives in one public GitHub repo: the kit, the full docs, and the sample project.

github.com/EthanHalf/vibe-editing-studio

1 **Clone it and run setup.** Setup installs the dependencies and runs a health check.

```
git clone https://github.com/EthanHalf/vibe-editing-studio.git
cd vibe-editing-studio
./setup.sh
```

2 **Open the folder in Claude Code** and say:

> **"Set up Vibe Editing Studio for me"**

The assistant walks you through your brand, your keys, and a **sample project** (a synthetic test clip and test covers) so you see a real result before using your own footage.

3 **Then make something:**

> **"Edit this video: path/to/take.mp4"**

> **"Make a thumbnail for it: headline MY FIRST AI-EDITED VIDEO"**

MAKE IT YOURS

Your brand is a preset file, not something you're stuck with: copy **brand/presets/default.json**, change the colors and font, and pass it with **--preset**.

WORTH KNOWING

- **Tested end-to-end:** the offline caption chain (local Whisper, no key) and the cover builder, both brand presets and both output sizes.
- **Not yet run:** a clean install on a fresh Mac and the full /edit workflow. Treat your first setup as the real test; the built-in health check (doctor.py) names anything missing and how to fix it. Always watch the rendered clip and cover before posting.

Hey, message me @vibecodeceo to let me know how you like this guide, and what you make with it.

Vibe Editing Studio is free and open source (MIT), built on the open-source Vibe Editing plugin. Credit in NOTICE.md.